





the contemporary supper club as we know it (intimate and chef-driven,) was reborn in London in the early 2000s when pioneers like Kerstin Rodgers hosted dinners from her North London flat. India, with its ancient tradition of daawat (elaborate home feast) was, in many ways, always ready for this.

The Luxury of the Unrepeatable

What makes supper clubs feel distinctly luxurious is the exclusivity and experience "A supper club is designed to be specific, personal and a little experimental. It gives us the freedom to put things on the table that you will never find on a restaurant menu," says Archit Agarwal. The menu changes every time. The guest list rarely exceeds twenty. The host cooks feet from the table, narrating stories. You will not eat this meal again. It exists, briefly, brilliantly and then it is gone. The bigger draw, though, is connection. "Our parents had dinner parties," says Taneja of V's Supper Stories. "That infrastructure of informal gathering that built community without anyone having to engineer it, that's largely gone. We've replaced it with restaurants that are too loud to have a real conversation and social media that keeps us connected to everyone while making us feel close to no one." A supper club, she argues, fills that gap in the most natural way possible. And India's affluent, well-travelled diners educated on Noma's philosophy of terroir and on the locavore movement has embraced it wholeheartedly. Ask anyone who has attended a supper club what made it memorable and the answer is rarely the food alone. It is the conversation. The intimacy of sitting beside a stranger who becomes, by the third course, someone you are genuinely curious about. You eat what the chef decides, sit where you are placed, arrive not knowing what the evening holds. For a generation accustomed to on-demand everything, this relinquishing of control is liberating. For India's luxury consumer, who has dined at Michelin-starred restaurants from Tokyo to Copenhagen, the supper club offers something those hallowed institutions simply cannot: the feeling of being personally welcomed. Not attended to. Welcomed.